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EXPERIMENTS GALORE AS INDIA CHASES STABILITY AHEAD OF WORLD CUP

As the Women in Blue continue their **winning surge** with a recent tri-series triumph, a few chinks in the armour still remain to be addressed.

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There's great comfort in being the reliable bet when success is largely on autopilot. Ask India, the hot favourite in the recent tri-series against Sri Lanka and South Africa in Colombo. Harmanpreet & Co. cantered to a series win, after beating Sri Lanka in a final that was headlined by a sublime century from Smriti Mandhana (**right**). The Women in Blue



dominated every game in the series they played, barring one, where they could not defend 275, handing the Lankans their second-highest successful chase and just their third win over India in the format.

This outing in the island nation was a statement run for India's batting order. Pratika Rawal (**above**) has made hay under the shining sun of Shafali Verma's absence from the team, becoming the fastest player to 500 ODI runs — doing so in just eight innings. She surpassed England great Charlotte Edwards, who did so in nine.